

Exodus Pocket Bible

Original Proposal

Summary

This action platformer expands on the melee combat of Megaman Zero and the directional aiming of Metroid. Free aim, parry, and cut down the malfunctioning cyber guardians of the human colony ship Exodus.

Gameplay

Gameplay loop

The player moves through the level and defeats enemies until they reach the gate for the miniboss, then the gate for the boss. After defeating the boss the game transitions to the next level.

Major mechanics

1. The player can dash, jump, and jump between walls.
2. The player can freely aim the arm cannon on their left arm, which follows the mouse cursor. The player can also slash enemies with an energy sword. They can also parry enemy attacks, which stuns them allowing for a finisher.
3. The player can heal by picking up health pips dropped by defeated enemies. The player can also heal by holding down a key to slowly regen health, while being unable to move. In this idle state, releasing the key at the right time will release a high damage slash from the sword.

User interfaces

UI elements will include the start menu, the player's health bar, miniboss and boss health bars, and a key icon above stunned enemies heads indicating that the player can perform a finisher. The arm cannon and energy sword will also have key icons in the middle of the screen when first introduced, as a tutorial.

Art and Visuals

Inspirations

The first game I'm going to be drawing from is the psp remake of Megaman X, Maverick Hunter X. This game is 2.5D and slims down the classic chunky designs from Megaman X.



Maverick Hunter X (2005)

The second game is Ultimate Ghosts 'n Goblins, another 2.5D sidescroller Capcom psp game. It's a mashup of the first three Ghosts 'n Goblins games, and is visually dark.



Ultimate Ghosts 'n Goblins (2006)

Art Style

I'm going for a clean, 2.5D polygonal style. The game's lighting will range from harsh to dim in different areas of the colony ship. I originally wanted to go with a low poly style, I'm a big fan of Deeprock Galactic's utilization of the style as a game built around destructible voxel environments. However, its style is intentionally chunky, similar to the original Megaman and Megaman X designs. Instead I'll be following Maverick Hunter X's clean polygonal style, with 3D models in a 2D sidescroller.

Prototype Details

My prototype will contain the following features.

- Basic movement.
- Player and enemy health.
- An arm cannon that follows the mouse cursor.
- A basic energy sword attack.
- The first level, along with miniboss and boss gates, which will lead to empty arenas that these bosses will later occupy.
- The game's basic grunt enemy, which will be stationary but can fire the same pellet projectile as the player.

In my prototype, players will move through the first level and reach a win screen when entering the boss arena. They'll encounter the basic grunts with ranged weapons, but they'll be stationary. They'll be able to dispatch the grunts with basic attacks from the arm cannon and energy sword.

Credits

I used Lexend as the UI font

<https://fonts.google.com/specimen/Lexend?preview.script=Latn>

Most music tracks are from megaman x gamerips as listed below, and sfx are from freesound.org.

Music:

Intro cutscene and level 1 theme

<https://downloads.khinsider.com/game-soundtracks/album/mega-man-x3-snes>

Title theme and saber theme

<https://downloads.khinsider.com/game-soundtracks/album/mega-man-x2-snes>

Difficulty selection, level 2 and 3, boss, lore, ending screen themes

<https://downloads.khinsider.com/game-soundtracks/album/mega-man-x-snes-gamerip>

Final boss elevator

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=juVZ0TN_2EA

Final boss

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BmvQtTVFjYU>

Game Over

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PbmKzEgYfWI>

Sfx:

Jump

Jump EU FX by FunnyVoices -- <https://freesound.org/s/709045/> -- License: Creative Commons 0

Dash

Fast whoosh by mokasza -- <https://freesound.org/s/810736/> -- License: Attribution 4.0

Pellet Projectile

projectile.wav by jeckkech -- <https://freesound.org/s/391660/> -- License: Creative Commons 0

Sabre

lightsaber3.mp3 by gyzhor -- <https://freesound.org/s/47125/> -- License: Creative Commons 0

Impact

8-Bit Hit by TheDweebMan -- <https://freesound.org/s/277213/> -- License: Creative Commons 0

Battery Pip

item-pickup-v2.wav by DeltaCode -- <https://freesound.org/s/678385/> -- License: Creative Commons 0

Door

Garage Door Handle Pull by Ev-Dawg -- <https://freesound.org/s/344942/> -- License: Attribution 3.0

Parry

Metal_Sword_Parry_Impact_Hit_4 by chungkury -- <https://freesound.org/s/760636/> -- License: Creative Commons 0

Block

Punch/Kick Being Blocked by elynch0901 -- <https://freesound.org/s/464498/> -- License: Creative Commons 0

Dev comments

As shown in the original proposal, the game was supposed to use 3d models in a similar style to the psp remake of Megaman X. The remixed music in the remake would fit my game better than the snes tracks, but I'm very partial to the snes tracks... they're also objectively better!

The Exodus is an overt reference to The Marathon.

The game over screen has an overt reference to the game over screen in mgs1, and a slightly more subtle one to mgs2's fake out game over screen near the end of the game.

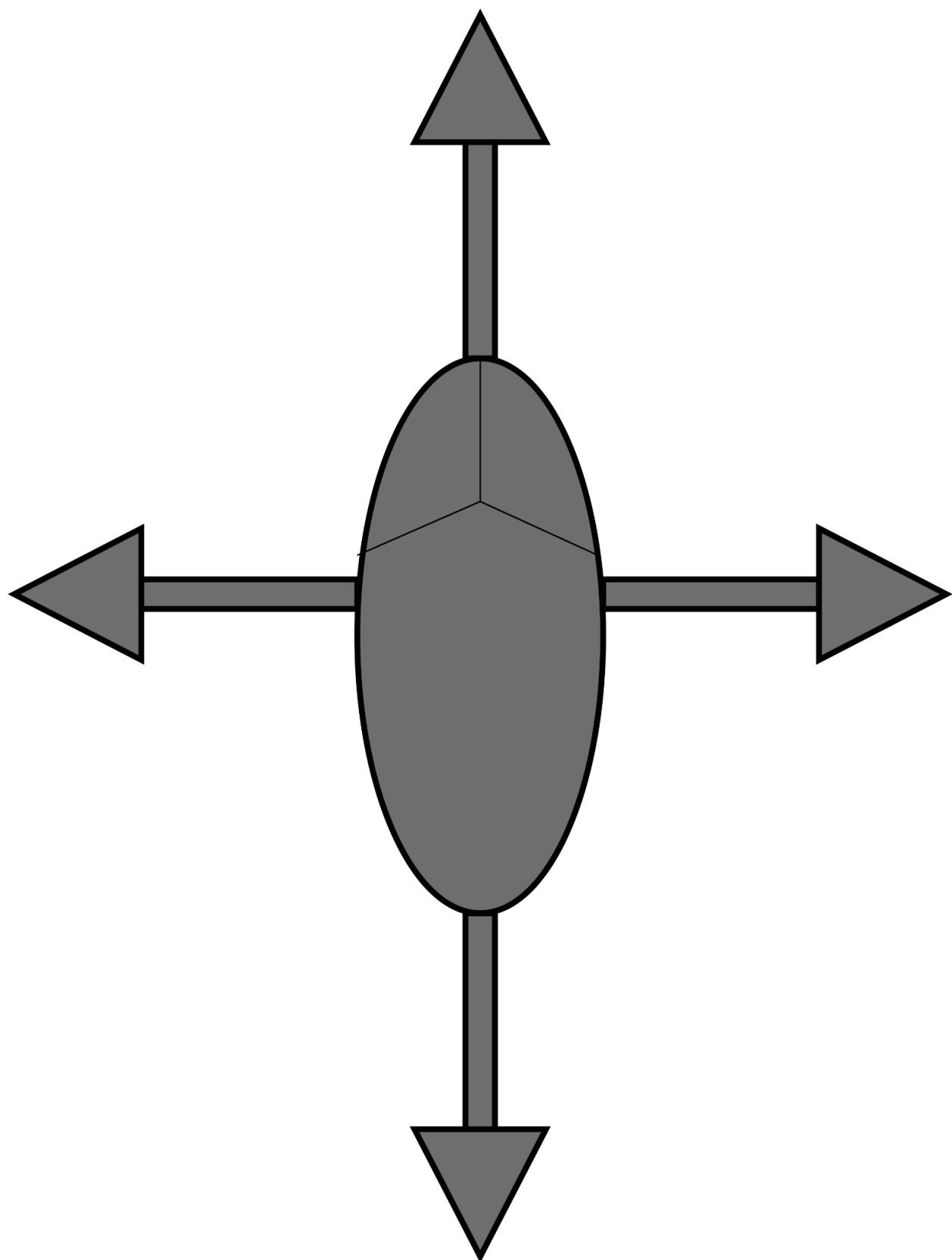
I finally downloaded the yt-dlp cli tool while working on Exodus, no clue why I put it off so long.

The reticle was surprisingly easy to make, I just drew two circles and four squares in illustrator then assigned the png to the cursor in settings. Same thing for the key and mouse tutorial icons.

I batch changed all of the UI text in my game to lexend by changing the source font and the fallback font file for the default font text mesh pro gives you. There's probably a much more elegant way to do that...

The mouse image is my mouse, logitech g305





FEELINGS OF POWER

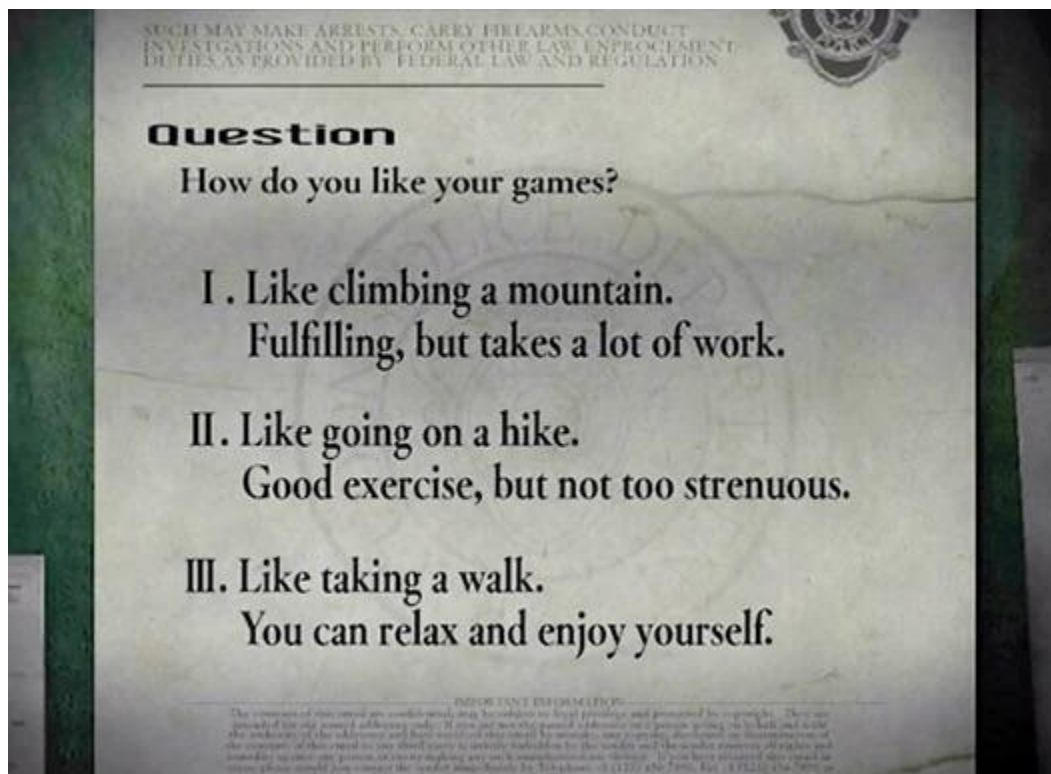


Scrapped ideas

Before changing the setting to a colony ship, I had a vaguely similar plot in mind to megaman zero. The player would be a revolutionary android, who turned on the rebellion after disagreeing with their methods. I also considered a twist ending, where it would be revealed that the player was the only android on the ship, and the integer overflow affected them instead. The error would have opened every human cryopod, and the player would mistakenly see players as rogue androids.

I considered making a jukebox menu to switch between snes and psp tracks.

Furthermore, I thought about making a menu to choose the mgs3 ladder music (the short elevator before the final boss)



What type of music do you like when climbing obscenely long ladders?

I like hideo games

- Mgs3
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=m2OR_JaXDaM

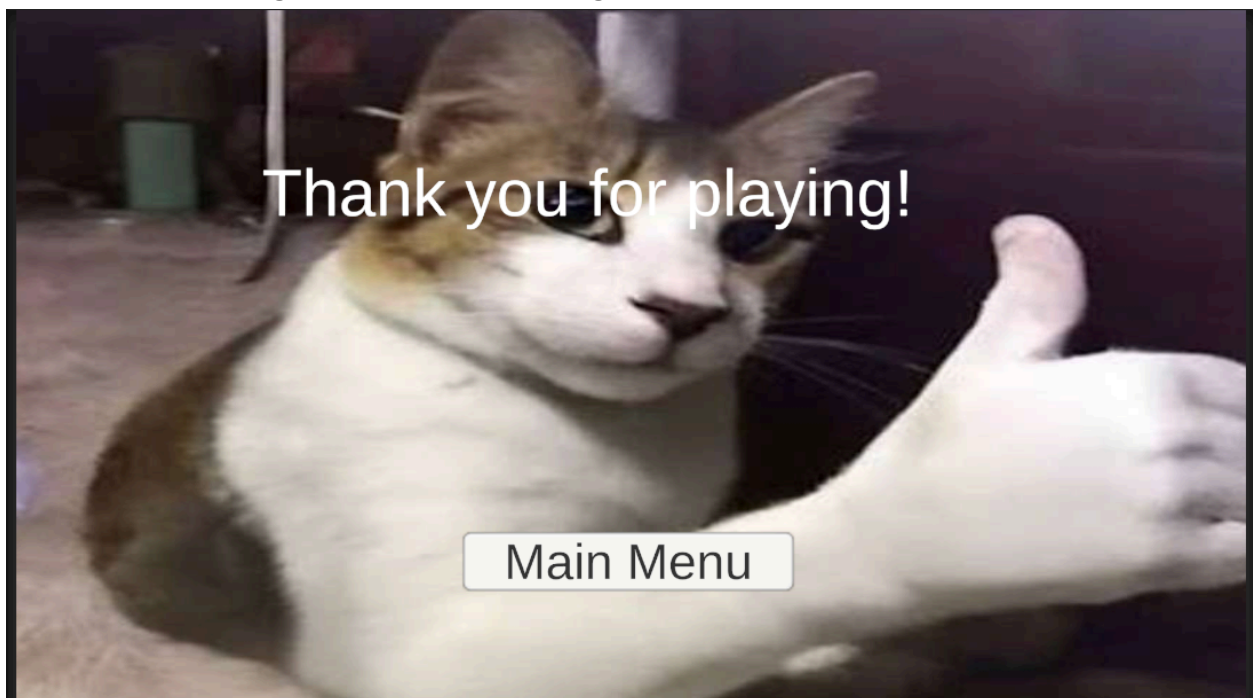
I like jrpgs

- Somnus
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=juVZ0TN_2EA

I like french jrpgs

- E33 track ladder
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BmvQtTVFjYU>
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8HXOEackrso>
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0FVRRBtc3Xo>

Had to avoid making Exodus into a meme game



Master Script

Intro cutscene

In 2036 after a decade of war, the remnants of humanity live on the base of an elevator to the moon, in the middle of the ocean off the coast of the Seychelles.

All land on Earth has become unsuitable for life following nuclear fallout.

Colony ship Exodus was built, piercing through the core of the moon.

The last of humanity has been placed in cryosleep, awaiting their arrival on a planet orbiting Alpha Centauri, the Grail.

They won't arrive until 2038.

This is their last chance.

Level 1

The title fades, and the scene fades to cryo pod

AEGIS falls out of the pod in the center of the room, drops down a tunnel

They land squarely, and stand up

The first hallway contains two mice tutorials for the buster, and the games first grunt

After boss 1

Exodus was outfitted with four androids, and dozens of simple humanoid frames to combat any hostile wildlife on the Grail.

After boss 2, large text

-2,147,483,648

After boss 3

Humanity paid no mind to Unix Epoch before launching the Exodus. When faced with immediate extinction, technical debt is rarely a priority.

They were wrong.

Mgs3 ladder

Aegis strikes down their creator

Thank you. The androids, every frame on the ship, and myself went rogue due to an integer overflow. You'll have to defend humanity yourself now.

Humanity lands on the Grail, an untainted world far from the ashes of Earth.

There's no reason to fight anymore.

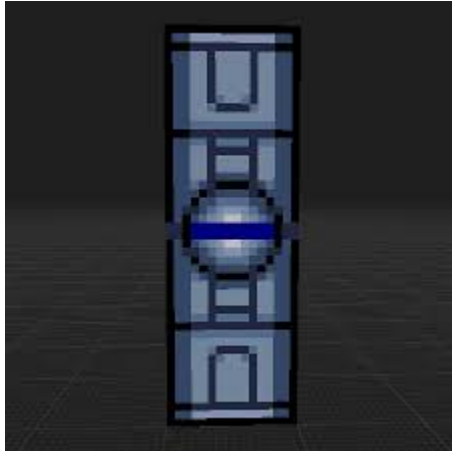
An alien wolf-like creature walks up to you.

It licks your hand.

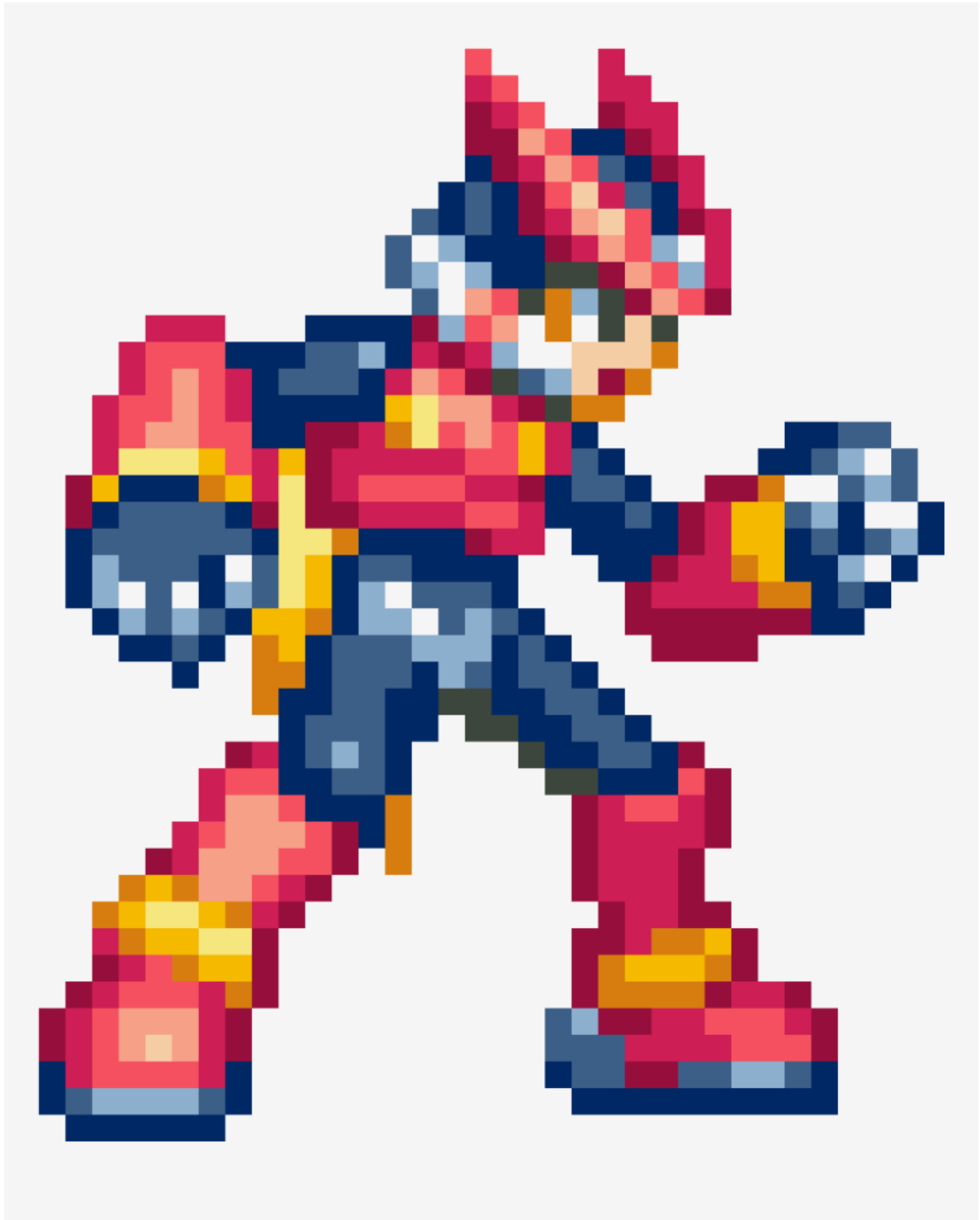
Fin.

Art references

Door (Megaman X)

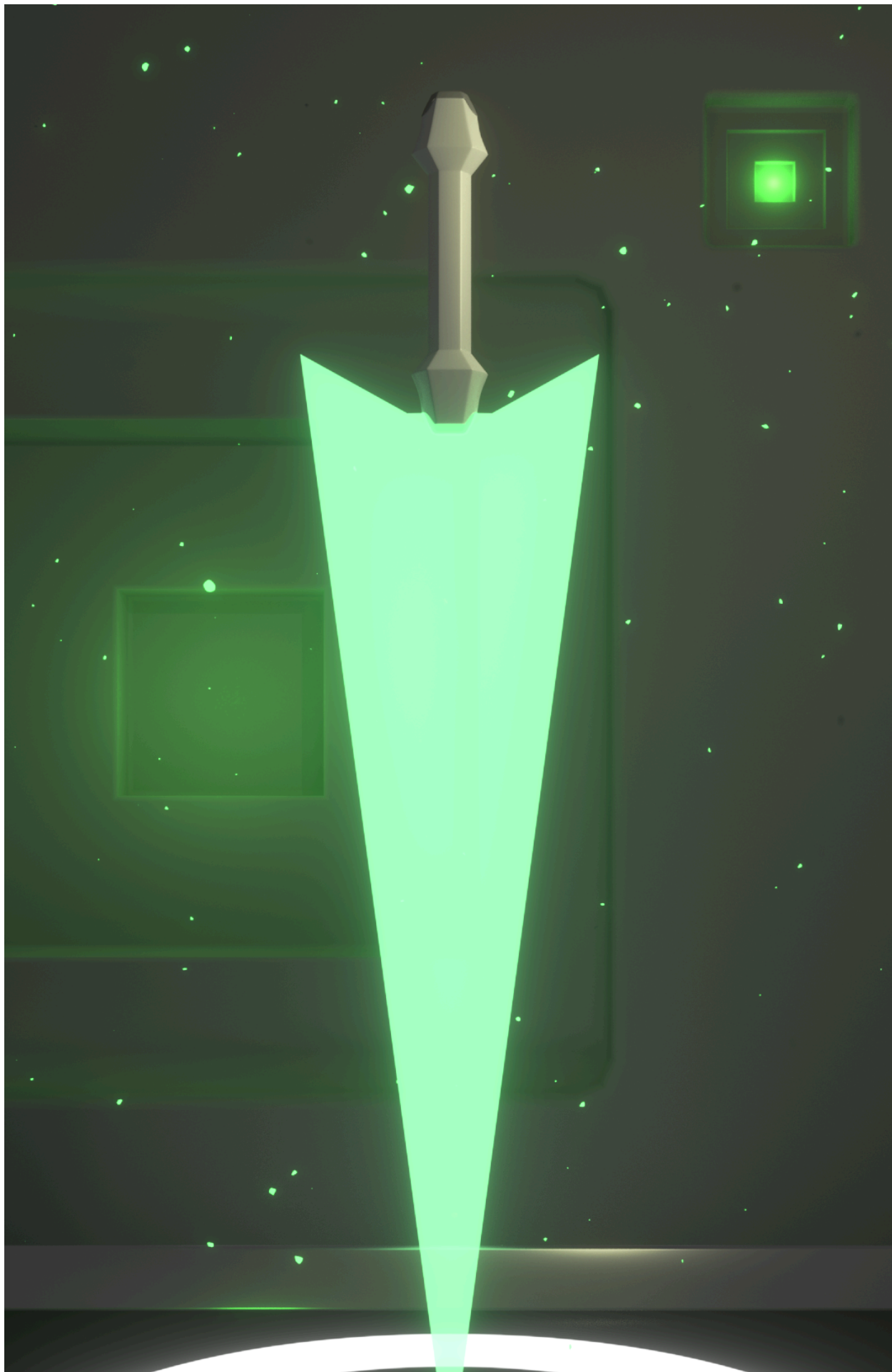


Aegis (Megaman Zero)





Sabre (Megaman Zero)



Battery/Health pip (Titanfall 2)



Grunt (Megaman Zero)



Cryopod (Megaman X)



Mech (Megaman X)

